



9th Grade English Language Arts

English 1 (Florida course 1001310) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · From Greek tragedy to American drama, united by one question: what do we owe?

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions, so the week-to-week experience varies; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

9th Grade ELA spans a wide range of genres and periods: ancient Greek tragedy, Middle English epic poetry, Chaucer, Shakespeare's sonnets, classic short stories, and the American novel and drama. Uniting them is the theme of justice and duty. Reading closely, scholars examine the intersection of faith, family, the state, and personal experience through the classical question of what is owed to others and to ourselves. Along the way they keep a reading journal, record spoken reflections, annotate the texts, and build every major essay step by step. VR workshops based on each module's literature accompany the reading.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 6 MODULES · 34 WEEKS

Module · Text	Weeks	Quarter	Focus & module project
1 · Justice in Greek Tragedy — <i>Electra</i> (Sophocles)	5	Q1	The House of Atreus, dramatic irony, what we owe the gods, the city, and our family; expository essay on justice built from a character chart and outline
2 · Honor & Duty in Arthurian Literature — <i>Sir Gawain and the Green Knight</i>	5	Q1–Q2	Chivalry, the journey motif, symbolism, tests of morality; disputatio (a formal classical argument), practiced playfully first, then composed in earnest
3 · Love, Laughter & Justice in Chaucer — <i>Canterbury Tales</i> (Prologue + three tales)	5	Q2	Satire, irony, social commentary; VR recitation of the General Prologue and a VR pilgrimage; argumentative essay: which tale is best?
4 · Shakespeare's Sonnets — 66, 94, 29, 116	3	Q2	The sonnet form, compared back to <i>Electra</i> and the medieval poems; an original sonnet + a cumulative compare-and-contrast essay
5 · Short Story Explorations — seven classic stories	8	Q3	"The Monkey's Paw," "The Lady or the Tiger?," "Lamb to the Slaughter," "The Sniper," "The Dinner Party," "There Will Come Soft Rains," "Death by Scrabble"; scholar-written short story
6 · Faith, Family & Fidelity in American Literature — <i>The Scarlet Letter</i> + <i>The Crucible</i>	8	Q4	Symbolism, guilt and redemption, hysteria and power; a research week (MLA, note-taking, annotated bibliography); final literary essay with a peer-reviewed draft

A TYPICAL WEEK

Strand	What the scholar does (~50 min/day, M–F)
Read	The week's assigned portion of the current text, read closely with annotations .
Write	Journal entries in the scholar's ePortfolio respond to the reading; project weeks shift this time to essay drafting.
Speak	An oral reflection , recorded as audio: the scholar says what they think and why, in their own voice.
VR	A VR workshop tied to the module's literature and writing objectives, on Optima's VR campus.
Project	Each module closes with a project week ; feeder assignments come due along the way so no essay is written in one sitting.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. Reading, journaling, and the oral reflection are the core of that time; VR workshops and annotation work fill out the rest. **Project weeks** can run longer, and slower readers should budget extra time for *The Scarlet Letter*.

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback on writing, and grading.
Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.

HOW THE WRITING IS BUILT

- ▶ Every major essay is scaffolded through **feeder assignments**: an organizer or character chart, an outline, then a draft
- ▶ The year climbs a ladder: expository essay → disputatio → argumentative essay → compare-and-contrast → original short story → researched literary essay
- ▶ Module 6 adds **research skills**: MLA formatting, note-taking, an annotated bibliography, and peer review of drafts
- ▶ Creative writing has a real place: an original sonnet in Module 4 and a complete short story in Module 5

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ Copies of the module texts (the teacher's section confirms editions and any provided readings)
- ▶ A computer with a web browser and a **microphone** for recorded oral reflections
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus: weekly workshops, the Prologue recitation, and the Canterbury pilgrimage
- ▶ An **ePortfolio journal**, kept all year and carried forward